SECTION 5: READING COMPREHENSION
Time -- 20 minutes
30 Questions (216 - 245)

NAME: _____
SCHOOL: _____
SIMULATED EXAM - SET B

Directions: Answer the questions below based on the information in the accompanying passages and compositions and then darken the corresponding oval on the answer sheet.

PASSAGE 1

Some say the world will end in fire,
Some say in ice.
From what I've tasted of desire
I hold with those who favor fire.
But if it had to perish twice,
I think I know enough of hate
To say that for destruction ice
Is also great
And would suffice.

– Robert Frost
Fire and Ice

216. The poem literally outlines the familiar question about the
   A. dichotomy between fire and ice.
   B. fate of the world.
   C. debate regarding fire and ice.
   D. none of the above.

217. The persona uses the term "some" instead of "I" or "an individual" to
   A. clarify that the given perspective about the fate of the world was not his view.
   B. assert that a group of people is on both sides of the debate about the distinction between the two elements.
   C. affirm that the difference between the two elements is a universal truth, and not just an idea promoted by an individual.
   D. attest that the presented idea cannot be formed by a single individual, but by a specific group of people having contradicting perspective about the divergence of fire and ice.

218. The poem figuratively introduced a metaphorical view of
   A. fire and ice.
   B. desire and hate.
   C. the world.
   D. the elements.

219. In the poem, the "world" can be recognized as a metaphor of
   A. relationship.
   B. fate.
   C. dreams.
   D. life.

220. Which of the following best summarizes the main point of the poem?
   A. Too much desire can quickly consume a relationship whereas hate can be equally destructive.
   B. The fate of an individual should not be directed or controlled by a debatable idea.
   C. Desire and passion strengthen one's dream, whereas hatred will possibly destroy it.
   D. The world is made up of contradicting ideas that create misunderstandings among people.

PASSAGE 2

For the young writer is almost certain to start his career by writing mushy poetry and sophomoric philosophy, permitting his fancy to reveal hedonistically among lovely phrases culled from books and sayings come down from the ancients - remnants of fascinating courses in literature and philosophy taken in college. Then slowly, almost imperceptibly, as the years pass, there comes over his writing a change not only in subject matter but in general temper and attitude.

Daily exposed to the headlines of the newspapers, his Olympian superiority or indifference yields slowly to the persistent hammering of the facts of his own experience and of contemporary history. Upon his sophomoric certainties is cast the shadow of terrible happenings - whole nations in the grip of terror, starved, maimed or killed through no fault of their own, pawns on the bloody game of men lustful for wealth and power crushed under the heels of the dictators. An amorphous idealism or, on other hand a presocious cynicism is no longer adequate to meet the vast problems which daily present themselves before his eyes.

Not that he has become blind to the beauty of nature and the works of man; it is only that he has begun to relate his ideas and every important thing that happens to some definite principles of beauty and justice and truth. His eyes have pierced through the veil of deception with which so much of the face of life that is ugly is covered. He has begun to pursue truth instead of phrases.

He is no longer a florist scissors in hand gathering lovely blossoms; he has become a tiller of the soil, spade in hand, digging into the roots of things and planting seeds.

– *Literature and Society*
Salvador P. Lopez

221. As it is used in the passage, the terms *mushy poetry* and *sophomoric philosophy* refer to
   A. poems and ideas that lack definition and precision.
   B. poems and ideas that cannot connect to the readers.
   C. poems that are too sentimental and ideas that are intellectually pretentious.
   D. poems that are too ambitious and ideas that are implicitly absurd.

222. Which of the following best describes the tone of the passage?
   A. indifference
   B. interested
   C. agitated
   D. prescriptive

223. In sentence 5, *amorphous* means
   A. passionate
   B. unstructured
   C. vague
   D. distinct

224. According to the passage, which of the following is NOT true?
   A. Works of art must portray the cruelties and ugliness of the real life.
   B. The maker of art should not be blinded by the beauty of nature.
   C. It is not a necessity that writer should always interact with the readers.
   D. Writer and his subject matter must be a reflection of the society.

225. What does the last paragraph signify?
   A. The writer is no longer blinded by the idea that works of art should always display pleasantries.
   B. The writer is no longer constrained in the idea that the maker of art should always create for the people within the society.
   C. The writer no longer creates a work of art that focused on beautiful things, but he starts to strike the core issues of society.
   D. The writer no longer sees the beauty in creating works for the pleasure of the readers.

PASSAGE 3

The student's biggest problem was a slave mentality which had been built into him by years of carrot-and -whip grading, a mule mentality which said, "If you don't whip me, I won't work." He didn't get whipped. He didn't work. And the cart of civilization, which he supposedly was being trained to pull, was just going to have to creak along a little slower without him.

This is a tragedy, however, only if you presume that the cart of civilization, "the system", is pulled by mules. This is a common, vocational, "location" point of view, but it's not the true

learning's attitude. True learning's attitude is that civilization, or " the system ", or "society", or whatever you want to call it, is best served not by mules but by free men. The purpose of abolishing grades and degrees is not to punish mules or to get rid of them, but to provide an environment in which that mule can turn into a free man.

The hypothetical student, still a mule, would drift around for a while. He would get another kind of education quite as valuable as the one he'd abandoned, in what used to be called the "school of hard knocks." Instead of wasting money and time as a high-status mule, he would now have to get a job as a low-status mule, maybe as a mechanic. Actually his real status would go up. He would be making a contribution for a change. Maybe that's what he would do for the rest of his life. Maybe he'd found his level. But don't count on it.

In time six months; five years, perhaps a change could easily begin to take place. He would become less and less satisfied with a kind of dumb, day-to-day shop work. His creative intelligence, stifled by too much theory and too many grades in college, would now become re-awakened by the boredom of the shop.

So he would come back to our degreeless and gradeless school, but with a difference. He'd no longer be a grade-motivated person. He'd be a knowledge-motivated person. He would need no external pushing to learn. His push would come from inside. He'd be a free man.

– *Zen and The Art of Motorcycle Maintenance*
Robert Pirsig

226. What is the main point of the passage?
   A. The overall academic system should be free from grades.
   B. The pressures of grades and acamedics put too much pressure on students, turning them into figurative mules.
   C. The hypothetical student tends to be naturally stubborn, like a mule.
   D. A low-status mule is more creative than a high-status mule.

227. What is being referred to as the high-status mule in the passage?
   A. Students who generally do not perform well in academics.
   B. Students who are intellectually gifted but slack off from school work.
   C. Students who put too much focus on the pressures of academics instead of on the passion for the knowledge instilled on them.
   D. Students who were once low-status mules who worked harder to gain higher status.

228. In the passage, the free man referred to
   A. someone who works and studies purely for the passion of the field.
   B. someone who became a mechanic out of academic frustration.
   C. someone who easily gets bored of mundane work, like one in a machine shop.
   D. someone who cannot afford a high-status job that belongs to high-status mules.

229. The purpose of this passage is to
   A. convince the reader.
   B. amuse the reader.
   C. educate the reader.
   D. enlighten the reader.

230. Which subject or field can this passage be most appropriately classified in?
   A. History
   B. Philosophy
   C. Literature
   D. Psychology

PASSAGE 4

[1]Pliant is the bamboo;
[2]I am man of earth;
[3]They say that from the bamboo
[4]We had our first birth.

[5]Am I of the body,
[6]Or of the green leaf?
[7]Do I have to whisper
[8]My every sin and grief?

[9]If the wind passes by,
[10]Must I stoop and try
[11]To measure fully
[12]My flexibility?

[13]I might have been the bamboo,
[14]But I will be a man.
[15]Bend me then, O Lord,
[16]Bend me if you can.

– *Man of Earth*
Amador T. Daguio

231. Which of the following is true about the persona in the poem?
   A. The persona directly compares the man to bamboo.
   B. The persona rejects the imposition of a mythic provenance.
   C. The persona believes in the idea that the first man and woman came from a bamboo.
   D. The persona presents his belief about the origin of man on earth.

232. Which of the following best describes the tone of the persona in the second stanza?
   A. scornful
   B. perplexed
   C. wondrous
   D. confused

233. In line 9, the wind represents
   A. danger.
   B. adversity.
   C. handicap.
   D. punishment.

234. What literary device can be seen in the poem?
   A. metaphor
   B. personification
   C. hyperbole
   D. paradox

235. In lines 15-16, the persona is most likely
   A. assured.
   B. gratified.
   C. alarmed.
   D. terrified.

PASSAGE 5

The Greek philosophers Democritus (460 BC), Plato, Pythagoras, and the school of the Stoics gave astrology their sanction and elevated it to pseudo-science. The idea that man's life on earth and destiny for good or for evil is subject to the heavenly bodies and their relative positions was current in the early centuries of the Christian Era; astronomical tables were in common use on which were marked the lucky and the unlucky days and even hours.

As the centuries rolled on, belief in astrology grew apace and exerted a baleful influence on mankind, arousing alarming fears and extravagant hopes always doomed to disappointment; it kept the intellect in a "dreary bondage of ignorance and superstition." preventing the growth of true science "by the incessant operation of prejudice and slavery of imbecile apprehensions." In the thirteenth century astronomy was rarely cultivated for its own sake; the movements of the moon and planets were studied with a view to determining holy days, and the stars were observed for the purpose of casting horoscopes.

For several centuries the rising and setting of the stars, the eclipses of the sun and moon, the appearance of the comets, the aspects, conjunctions,

and oppositions of the planets, were thought to be intimately related to the production as well as the relief of diseases. The moon was believed to have special power over mental and bodily maladies, as well as over the weather and minor concerns of life, – a superstition that still lingers even in enlightened minds. The position of the moon in the constellations determined the proper time for compounding and administering medicines, – a belief current at a very early period among Anglo-Saxons.

– *A Relic of Astrology*
H. Carrington Bolton

236. The word baleful in the second paragraph is synonymous to
   A. eventual.
   B. hopeless.
   C. malevolent.
   D. playful.

237. The second and third paragraphs
   A. demonstrate how astrology was used in the past so it can be properly applied in today's time.
   B. give historical examples to prove the negative impact astrology has made in the past.
   C. give a chronological development of astrology's evolution.
   D. demonstrate that measurements made by astrologers in the past are as accurate as the ones made today.

238. The word *sanction* used in context in the first paragraph is synonymous to
   A. punishment.
   B. penalty.
   C. skepticism.
   D. approval.

239. What can be the best concluding statement for the passage?
   A. With modern technology to measure the smallest forces emanating from gravitational fields from planets and stars, we now know they have absolutely no influence over health, diseases, and probable outcomes.
   B. Summing up the numerous influences of astrology in the past, it is difficult to come by without it in our daily lives.
   C. Astrology has brought such a negative impact on our society that it has absolutely prevented the growth of true science.
   D. Astrology has become a lucrative economic stronghold for scam artists causing the loss of billions of dollars worldwide.

240. The purpose of the passage is to
   A. educate the reader.
   B. rebuke the reader.
   C. criticize the reader.
   D. appease the reader.

PASSAGE 6

In the woods here in Oregon there is a creature that eats squirrels like candy, can kill a pursuing dog in less than a second, and is in the habit of deftly flipping over porcupines and scooping out the meat as if the prickle-pig were merely a huge and startled breakfast melon.

This riveting creature is the fisher, a member of the mustelid family that includes weasels, otter, mink, badger, ferrets, marten, and — at the biggest and most ferocious end of the family — wolverine. Sometimes called the pekan or fisher-cat, the fisher can reach three feet long, tail included, and weigh up to 12 pounds.

I am a guy who wanders around looking for nothing in particular, which is to say everything. In this frame of mind I have seen many things, in venues urban, suburban and rural. While ambling in the woods I have seen marten kits and three-legged elk

and secret beds of watercress and the subtle dens of foxes.

Suffice it to say that I have been much graced in these woods, but to see a fisher was not a gift I expected. Yet recently I found loose quills on a path, and then the late owner of the quills, with his or her conqueror atop the carcass staring at me.

I do not know if the fisher had ever seen a human being before. It evinced none of the usual sensible caution of the wild creature confronted with *homo violencia*, and it showed no inclination whatsoever to retreat from its prize. We stared at each other for a long moment and then I sat down, thinking that a reduction of my height and a gesture of repose might send the signal that I was not dangerous, and had no particular interest in porcupine meat. Plus, I'd remembered that a fisher can slash a throat in less than a second.

Long minutes passed. The fisher fed, cautiously. I heard thrushes and wrens. I made no photographs or recordings, and when the fisher decided to evanesce I did not take casts of its tracks, or claim the former porcupine as evidence of fisherness. I just watched and listened and now I tell you. I don't have any heavy message to share. I was only a witness: Where there are no fishers, there was a fisher. It was a stunning creature, alert, attentive, accomplished, unafraid. I think maybe there is much where we think there is nothing. Where there are no fishers, there was a fisher. Remember that.

– *Fishering*
Brian Doyle

241. What creature was the fisher the author has encountered eating?
   A. marten
   B. badger
   C. porcupine
   D. elk

242. What was the author most likely feel when he saw the fisher?
   A. fear
   B. vigilance
   C. aggravation
   D. satisfaction

243. The word repose in the fifth paragraph means
   A. tranquility
   B. agitation
   C. deceit
   D. affability

244. What does *evanesce* mean in the last paragraph?
   A. disappear
   B. escape
   C. hide
   D. hibernate

245. What does the author imply in the sentence "Where there are no fishers, there was a fisher."?
   A. Fishers are shy creatures that are quite elusive.
   B. Fishers are unpredictable and can possible kill you in a fraction of a second.
   C. You can easily stumble into a fisher when you are not expecting an encounter.
   D. The recorded population statistics of fishers are wrong.